

PERSONA / HIGH SCHOOL HISTORY

Maya Rivera

A curious, game-loving sophomore who wants world history to feel like a living puzzle, not a march through dates.



AGE	15
GRADE	10th
CONTEXT	AP World / honors history curious
TIME	20-minute bursts after school
DEVICE	Phone first, school laptop second

COMPARATIVE LENS

trade routes

belief systems

empire choices

revolution patterns

what-if simulations

WANTS

- Compare civilizations through causes, tradeoffs, and human choices
- Feel agency: choose paths, debate outcomes, test alternate histories
- Earn stronger essays without memorizing isolated facts
- Use humor, mystery, and competition to stay locked in

FRICTIONS

- Textbook chapters blur together when every empire sounds the same
- Timelines feel flat unless events connect across regions
- Gets bored by passive videos that do all the thinking for her
- Worries that games may be fun but not serious enough for class

LEARNS BY

- Building comparison maps and cause-effect chains
- Role-playing diplomats, merchants, reformers, and rebels
- Turning review into short quests, card sorts, debates, and simulations
- Checking herself with quick feedback before writing

DESIGN FOR

- Scenario cards: 'What changes if the monsoon fails?'
- Civilization mashups that reveal patterns across time and place
- Mystery dossiers where sources unlock claims for an essay
- Boss battles against misconceptions, not just multiple choice

" Make me feel like I'm solving history, not just surviving it.

MAYA